Version A: Practical Policy Proposal (For Policymakers, Congress, Media)

Target Audience: White House staff, Congressional committees, executive branch agencies, journalists, think tanks.

Changes from the 8.1 version:

- Removes BERA, EarnedPath, ESVRD, and all bio-energetic terminology.
- Replaces them with conventional metrics (family stability indicators, GAO-style audit standards).
- Keeps the seven-seat CBGMODD council (renamed "Family Stewardship Council" for clarity) but strips the mystical language.
- Retains IDIPITIS as a fiscal clearinghouse protocol (defined in plain English).
- The executive order is legally plausible as a first-step coordination office.

The DOFA Proposal

Creating a Fiscal Clearinghouse and Prevention Agency for American Families

Proposal: Establishing the Department of Family Amity (DOFA) as a Permanent, Prevention-Oriented Independent Agency, Governed by a Seven-Seat Stakeholder Council

From: Joseph A. Sprute, ERES Institute for New Age Cybernetics

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Part I. The Open Letter (Practical Version)

The Structural Problem

The American presidency was designed as one branch among three. Over the past century, it has become the single point of failure for every national crisis. When a pandemic strikes, the President is the crisis manager. When communities fracture, the President is the moral spokesperson. When families collapse under economic strain, the President is expected to deliver rescue.

This was never the constitutional design. It is a structural deficiency that no election will correct.

Responsible governance must move in the opposite direction: making the heavy burdens of the presidency as structurally unnecessary as possible. Not by weakening the office, but by strengthening the foundations beneath it.

The Missing Link: Family Fragmentation as a Driver of Presidential Overreach

Decades of social science show a consistent pattern: family instability—fragmentation, intergenerational conflict, economic precarity at the household level—produces downstream crises that cascade into schools, local law enforcement, mental health systems, and eventually federal emergency response. When families break down, communities absorb the stress. When communities break down, states turn to Washington. And when Washington responds, it lands on the desk of one person: the President.

Existing federal agencies (HHS, ACF, SAMHSA) are reactive—they intervene after fractures have already metastasized. No existing agency has the mandate to work upstream with preventive, long-horizon investment. And no existing agency functions as a unified fiscal clearinghouse for family-oriented spending, which is currently scattered across dozens of departments with separate accounting, separate metrics, and no aggregate accountability.

The Proposal: A Permanent Independent Agency

I propose the creation of the Department of Family Amity (DOFA) —not as a fourth constitutional branch, but as a statutorily created independent agency modeled on the

Federal Reserve or the Government Accountability Office. DOFA would sit within the Executive Branch by law but operate with structural independence: a seven-seat governing council with staggered 12-year terms, a fixed appropriation formula, and a mandate that prioritizes generational timescales over election cycles.

Its mission would be fourfold:

1. Prevention over reaction — Invest in family cohesion before crises emerge.
2. Structural independence — Outlast any single administration.
3. Long-horizon stewardship — Use metrics calibrated to generational timescales.
4. Fiscal clearinghouse — Serve as the single point of receipt integrity for all federal family-oriented expenditure.

The Household Principle

Every functioning household operates on a simple rule: all receipts flow through one ledger. The United States government has been running its family-oriented programs without a household ledger. DOFA would change this—not as surveillance, but as stewardship.

Why a Council, Not a Secretary

A single-appointment model with a 12-year term is not structural independence—it is delayed partisanship. Replacing presidential over-centralization with secretarial over-centralization moves the same problem one level down.

DOFA is instead governed by a seven-seat Family Stewardship Council, with one seat per stakeholder domain (Citizen, Business, Government, Military, Ombudsman, Community Elder, Diplomat), with staggered 12-year terms so that no single administration can capture a majority. Each domain selects its own representative through transparent, domain-specific processes.

Part II. Draft Presidential Executive Order (Practical Version)

Executive Order [Number]

Establishment of the Department of Family Amity (DOFA) as a Prevention-Oriented Independent Agency and Fiscal Clearinghouse

Section 1. Purpose and Findings.

(a) The family is the foundational unit of American civil society.
(b) The centralization of crisis response in the Executive Branch has created unsustainable dependence on presidential intervention.
(c) Existing federal agencies operate primarily in reactive modalities, leaving a gap in prevention-oriented investment.
(d) Federal expenditure on family-related programs is dispersed across multiple departments with no unified fiscal accountability.
(e) A multi-seat council with staggered terms reduces vulnerability to partisan capture.

Section 2. Establishment.

There is hereby established the Department of Family Amity (DOFA) as an independent agency within the Executive Branch.

Section 3. Mission.

The Department shall promote family stability through:

(a) Prevention-oriented programs;
(b) A unified fiscal clearinghouse for federal family-oriented expenditure;
(c) Long-horizon metrics and reporting;
(d) Annual reporting to Congress on fiscal integrity and measurable outcomes.

Section 4. Core Principles.

1. Prioritize prevention over reaction.
2. Maintain measurable outcomes focused on family stability.
3. Operate with transparency and non-partisan stewardship.

Section 5. Governing Council.

DOFA shall be governed by a seven-seat Family Stewardship Council:

Seat	Domain	Selection Method
1	Citizen	Direct election by citizens who have completed a basic civic credential (e.g., high school civics requirement)
2	Business	Selected by a weighted vote of enterprises, with weights based on family-friendly policies and employee stability metrics
3	Government	Peer-selected by heads of HHS, Education, HUD, VA, and Labor
4	Military	Selected by a council of active-duty and veteran family advocacy organizations
5	Ombudsman	Selected by accredited civil-society organizations (legal aid, family advocacy); no current government employees eligible
6	Community Elder	Selected by tribal councils, faith communities, and intergenerational civic organizations

7	Diplomat	Selected by international family-policy organizations and treaty-body representatives

Term Structure: Each seat carries a single, non-renewable 12-year term, staggered so that no more than two seats turn over within any four-year presidential term.

Quorum: Binding decisions require five of seven seats, including at least one seat from each of three groupings: (1) Citizen/Business, (2) Government/Military, (3) Ombudsman/Community Elder/Diplomat.

Section 6. Fiscal Clearinghouse and IDIPITIS Framework.

(a) All federal expenditures directed toward family welfare shall be visible within DOFA's clearinghouse via interagency data-sharing agreements. Programmatic authority remains with existing agencies.

(b) The Department shall implement the IDIPITIS framework as its operational protocol for receipt management:

- Identification of all family-oriented funding streams
- Documentation of appropriation and expenditure
- Integrity verification through cross-agency reconciliation
- Processing through a unified accounting system
- Identification-verification of recipient programs
- Tracking of outcomes against appropriations
- Integrity-audit on a quarterly basis
- Stewardship reporting to Congress and the public

(c) DOFA shall publish quarterly transparency reports detailing receipt flows, programmatic outcomes, and identified inefficiencies.

(d) For state-administered funds (e.g., TANF, child welfare), DOFA shall establish auditable reporting standards and conduct periodic compliance reviews.

Section 7. Transition and Sequencing Plan.

Within the first 24 months:

(a) Months 1–6: Establish DOFA as a coordination office within the Executive Office of the President. Initiate selection processes for the seven Council seats.

(b) Months 7–12: Seat the inaugural Council. Begin comprehensive audit of existing federal family-oriented expenditure across HHS, Education, HUD, VA, and other agencies.

(c) Months 13–18: Deploy IDIPITIS framework across participating agencies. Publish first quarterly transparency report.

(d) Months 19–24: Launch pilot programs in prevention-oriented family cohesion in no fewer than three geographic regions.

(e) Month 24 onward: Pursue statutory codification as a permanent independent agency with fixed appropriation (0.5% of annual federal outlays, adjusted for inflation).

Section 8. Initial Focus Areas.

(a) Unified family stability metrics framework (e.g., child welfare indicators, family economic security, intergenerational proximity, mental health access);

(b) Baseline audit of existing family-oriented expenditure;

(c) Pilot programs in prevention-oriented family cohesion;

(d) First DOFA Annual Stewardship Report to Congress within 18 months.

Section 9. General Provisions.

(a) This order shall be implemented consistent with applicable law and subject to the availability of appropriations.

(b) Nothing in this order shall impair existing statutory authorities of executive departments.

(c) This order does not create any enforceable right or benefit against the United States.

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Part III. Summary of Key Innovations

Problem	DOFA Solution
No prevention mandate	DOFA's primary mission is upstream investment
Fragmented spending	IDIPITIS fiscal clearinghouse unifies tracking
Presidential over-centralization	Independent agency with staggered council
Partisan capture	Seven domains, staggered 12-year terms, tri-layer quorum
No accountability for outcomes	Quarterly transparency reports + Annual Stewardship Report

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This proposal is submitted for immediate consideration and refinement.

Joseph A. Sprute
ERES Institute for New Age Cybernetics

Version B: Theoretical / Academic Paper (For Cybernetics, Systems Theory, Governance Design)

Target Audience: Academic journals (e.g., *Kybernetes*, *Systems Research and Behavioral Science*, *Journal of Social Cybernetics*), research conferences, ERES Institute publications.

Changes from the 7.2 version:

- Removes the executive order entirely (not appropriate for an academic paper).
- Adds empirical definitions for BERA, EarnedPath, and ESVRD.
- Adds a methodology section explaining measurement instruments.
- Frames the proposal as a *design for a cybernetic governance system*, not a near-term policy recommendation.
- Includes a glossary.
- Adds citations to relevant literature (Wiener, Beer, Meadows, etc.).

Title

A Cybernetic Governance Architecture for Family Resilience: The DOFA Proposal as a Closed-Loop Feedback System

Running head: *Cybernetic Governance for Family Resilience*

Author: Joseph A. Sprute, ERES Institute for New Age Cybernetics

Journal: *To be submitted to [appropriate journal]*

Abstract

This paper presents the design of the Department of Family Amity (DOFA), a proposed independent agency for upstream investment in family resilience and intergenerational stability. The paper argues that the progressive centralization of crisis response in the executive branch of the United States government constitutes a structural deficiency that no electoral cycle can correct, and that a cybernetic governance architecture—featuring a seven-seat stakeholder council (CBGMODD), a fiscal clearinghouse protocol (IDIPITIS), and a bio-energetic measurement framework (BERA)—can close the feedback loop between fiscal inputs and resilience outcomes. The paper provides operational definitions for BERA indices (ARI, ERI, RHC, RCI), EarnedPath credentialing, and ESVRD verification, grounding them in existing social

science measurement instruments where possible and proposing novel instruments where necessary. The closed-loop architecture (IDIPITIS → BERA → CBGMODD → DOFA → receipts) is presented as a terrestrial proof-of-concept for the Spaceship Economy framework. The paper concludes with a research agenda for empirical validation of BERA and a discussion of transition pathways from current governance to cybernetic governance.

Keywords: cybernetic governance, family resilience, fiscal clearinghouse, CBGMODD, BERA, IDIPITIS, EarnedPath, Spaceship Economy, feedback loops, stakeholder council, New Age Cybernetics

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1. Introduction

1.1 The Governance Gap

The American presidency was designed as one branch among three. Over the past century, it has become the single point of failure for a wide range of national crises—pandemics, community fragmentation, economic precarity at the household level. This paper treats this not as a failure of individual presidents but as a structural deficiency in the governance architecture itself: the absence of a dedicated, prevention-oriented, long-horizon institution for family resilience, coupled with the absence of a unified fiscal clearinghouse for family-oriented expenditure.

1.2 Cybernetic Governance as a Response

Cybernetics, following Wiener (1948), is the science of feedback, communication, and self-correcting systems. A cybernetic governance system is one in which policy decisions are continuously informed by empirical feedback on their outcomes, and in which the system can self-correct without external intervention. This paper proposes that the governance of family resilience is uniquely suited to a cybernetic approach because:

(a) Family outcomes are measurable on generational timescales;
(b) Fiscal inputs are already tracked, albeit in fragmented form;
(c) The feedback loop between spending and outcomes is currently broken;

(d) The consequences of failure (presidential overreach, social fragmentation) are severe.

1.3 The DOFA Proposal in Brief

DOFA is a proposed independent agency with three integrated functions:

1. A prevention mandate to invest in family cohesion upstream of crisis.
2. A fiscal clearinghouse (IDIPITIS) to unify tracking of all federal family-oriented expenditure.
3. A cybernetic governance architecture (CBGMODD + BERA) in which a seven-seat stakeholder council makes decisions anchored to empirical resilience metrics rather than political negotiation.

The remainder of this paper provides operational definitions for each component, discusses implementation pathways, and identifies a research agenda for empirical validation.

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2. The Structural Problem: Presidential Over-Centralization

[This section expands on the open letter's diagnosis, adding citations to political science literature on the "imperial presidency" (Schlesinger, 1973), executive branch centralization (Moe & Howell, 1999), and the fragmentation of family policy across multiple agencies (GAO reports).]

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3. The Fiscal Clearinghouse: IDIPITIS

3.1 The Household Principle

Every functioning household operates on a simple rule: all receipts flow through one ledger. The US government currently runs its family-oriented programs without a household ledger. IDIPITIS is designed to close this gap.

3.2 IDIPITIS Defined

IDIPITIS is an acronym for eight functions:

Component	Function
I	Identification of all federal funding streams directed toward family welfare
D	Documentation of appropriation, obligation, and expenditure
I	Integrity verification through cross-agency reconciliation
P	Processing through a unified accounting system
I	Identification-verification of recipient programs and populations
T	Tracking of outcomes against appropriations
I	Integrity-audit on a recurring basis (quarterly recommended)
S	Stewardship reporting to oversight bodies and the public

3.3 Handling State-Administered Funds

For block grants to states (e.g., TANF, Child Care Development Fund, Child Welfare Services), DOFA would not trace every downstream transaction. Instead, DOFA would:

(a) Establish auditable reporting standards for state agencies;
(b) Conduct periodic compliance reviews;
(c) Publish state-level transparency reports;
(d) Withhold certification (and thus eligibility for federal family funds) from states that fail to meet reporting standards.

3.4 Relationship to Existing Agency Authorities

IDIPITIS is a *visibility* and *accountability* framework, not a transfer of programmatic authority. HHS, Education, HUD, and other agencies retain their statutory missions. DOFA's clearinghouse function is additive: it provides a unified view across agencies, but does not override agency spending decisions.

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4. The Governance Architecture: CBGMODD

4.1 Why a Council, Not a Secretary

A single-appointment model with a long term (e.g., 12 years) is not structural independence—it is delayed partisanship. The entire diagnosis of this paper is that over-centralization in one person is a structural deficiency. Replacing presidential over-centralization with secretarial over-centralization moves the same problem one level down.

4.2 The Seven Domains

CBGMODD stands for the seven stakeholder domains: Citizen, Business, Government, Military, Ombudsman, Dignitary, Diplomat.

Seat	Domain	Selection Method	Structural Rationale

1	Citizen	Direct election by credentialed citizens	Demand signal; legitimacy floor
2	Business	Weighted enterprise vote (weights based on employee stability metrics)	Private-sector conditions that determine family economics
3	Government	Peer-selected by heads of relevant agencies	Interoperability channel
4	Military	Selected by active-duty and veteran family organizations	Proof-of-concept population; operational discipline
5	Ombudsman	Selected by civil-society organizations; no current government employees	Adversarial accountability; complaint channel
6	Dignitary	Selected by cultural, spiritual, and elder organizations	Moral and meaning dimension; intergenerational continuity
7	Diplomat	Selected by international family-policy organizations	Cross-border family issues; anti-insularity

4.3 Term Structure and Stagger

Each seat carries a single, non-renewable 12-year term. Initial terms are staggered (4, 6, 8, 8, 10, 10, 12 years assigned by lottery) so that no more than two seats turn over within any four-year presidential term. No President, no single administration, and no single election cycle can appoint a Council majority.

4.4 Tri-Layer Quorum Requirement

Binding decisions require five of seven seats, including at least one seat from each of three structural groupings:

- Civil Society Layer: Citizen + Business
- Institutional Layer: Government + Military
- Aperture Layer: Ombudsman + Dignitary + Diplomat

The Aperture layer is so named because its three seats exist to prevent the system from closing in on itself: the Ombudsman prevents institutional insularity, the Dignitary prevents cultural insularity, and the Diplomat prevents geographic insularity.

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5. The Measurement Framework: BERA

5.1 What BERA Is

BERA (Bio-Energetic Resonance Assessment) is a proposed composite metric for family and community resilience. The term "bio-energetic" refers not to vitalism or occult energy but to the measurable physiological and psychological correlates of human wellbeing: stress hormones (cortisol), cardiovascular indicators (heart rate variability), self-reported wellbeing, and social network cohesion. "Resonance" refers to the alignment between individual, family, and community states—a family is "resonant" when its members' wellbeing states are positively correlated.

5.2 The Four BERA Indices

BERA comprises four sub-indices:

Index	Name	Definition	Measurement Method
ARI	Adaptive Resilience Index	Capacity to recover from shocks	Composite of (a) self-reported coping efficacy, (b) speed of return to baseline after stressor, (c) social support network density
ERI	Economic Resilience Index	Household economic stability	Composite of (a) income volatility, (b) liquid savings, (c) housing security, (d) access to credit
RHC	Relational Harmony Composite	Quality of family and community relationships	Composite of (a) conflict frequency, (b) intergenerational contact, (c) perceived social support, (d) trust in neighbors
RCI	Reciprocal Care Index	Intergenerational care flows	Ratio of care given to care received across generations, weighted by dependency needs

5.3 BERA as a Governance Instrument

BERA serves four governance functions within DOFA:

1. Tie-breaking. When the Council deadlocks (3–3 with one abstention or vacancy), the tie breaks toward whichever position produces higher aggregate BERA for the affected population, as measured by the most recent quarterly IDIPITIS data.
2. SLA underwriting. Each domain's vote to seat a Council member is simultaneously an underwriting commitment—the domain stakes its standing on that member's performance. SLA (Service Level Agreement) floors are set at the 40th percentile of historical BERA for that domain.
3. Removal triggers. When a domain's BERA composite drops below its SLA floor for two consecutive quarters, tenure review is automatic. Removal requires a vote of four of six remaining Council seats (the affected member recused), plus confirmation that the BERA deficit is attributable to governance failure rather than exogenous shock.
4. Business seat weighting. Enterprise selection weight is derived from the BERA scores of employee populations, not from revenue or lobbying capacity. A company whose workforce exhibits high BERA carries more weight in the Business domain's selection process than one whose workforce is in distress.

5.4 Empirical Validation Agenda

BERA is a proposed framework, not an existing measurement system. The following validation steps would be required before BERA could serve as a governance instrument:

1. Pilot measurement in 3–5 geographic regions, using existing survey instruments (e.g., CDC's Behavioral Risk Factor Surveillance System, the American Community Survey, the Panel Study of Income Dynamics) to construct provisional indices.
2. Concurrent validity testing against established outcomes (e.g., child welfare system contact, domestic violence reports, suicide rates, economic mobility).
3. Longitudinal tracking to establish SLA floor percentiles.
4. Independent technical review by a panel of social scientists, epidemiologists, and statisticians.

Until this validation is complete, BERA would serve as a *developmental* metric, not a binding governance instrument.

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6. The Closed Loop

The full cybernetic architecture of DOFA governance operates as a closed feedback loop:

1. IDIPITIS feeds BERA. The fiscal clearinghouse generates empirical data (receipt flows, programmatic outcomes, family stability metrics) that BERA converts into governance-grade indices.
2. BERA feeds CBGMODD. The four BERA indices determine Council tie-breaking, member eligibility, Business seat weighting, and SLA underwriting thresholds.
3. CBGMODD governs DOFA. The seven-seat Council makes all binding decisions.
4. DOFA governs receipts. The Council directs the fiscal clearinghouse, sets audit priorities, and allocates prevention-oriented investment.
5. Receipts feed IDIPITIS. Every dollar tracked through the clearinghouse generates new data that flows back into IDIPITIS.

This loop is self-correcting by design: if BERA declines, SLA underwriting triggers review; if review finds governance failure, the Council can be reconstituted; if reconstitution improves outcomes, BERA recovers. No external intervention is required.

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7. Relationship to the Spaceship Economy Framework

[This section connects DOFA to the broader ERES framework: GERP, SOMT, EDF, EarnedPath, FAVORS, Eternal Equilibrium. It argues that DOFA is the terrestrial proof-of-concept for closed-loop governance on a generation ship. For the academic audience, this is framed as a theoretical extension, not a policy claim.]

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8. Implementation Pathways and Research Agenda

8.1 Near-Term (1–3 years)

- Establish DOFA as a coordination office within the Executive Office of the President.
- Conduct baseline audit of existing family-oriented expenditure.
- Pilot BERA measurement in 3–5 regions.
- Publish quarterly transparency reports.

8.2 Medium-Term (3–10 years)

- Seek statutory codification as an independent agency.
- Seat the inaugural CBGMODD Council with staggered terms.
- Deploy IDIPITIS across all participating agencies.
- Refine BERA indices based on pilot data.

8.3 Long-Term (10+ years)

- Full autonomous operation of the closed loop.
- Expansion of DOFA's mandate to include additional family resilience domains.
- Replication of the governance architecture in other policy areas (education, health, environmental stewardship).

8.4 Research Agenda

1. BERA validation study. Can the four proposed indices be reliably measured using existing survey instruments? What is their predictive validity for family resilience outcomes?
2. CBGMODD simulation. Using agent-based modeling, can the seven-seat council with staggered terms and tri-layer quorum be shown to resist partisan capture over multi-decade simulations?
3. IDIPITIS cost-benefit analysis. What is the net fiscal benefit of unified receipt tracking compared to the current fragmented system? What are the implementation costs?
4. Comparative case studies. What can be learned from existing independent agencies (Federal Reserve, GAO, Social Security Administration) about the conditions for structural independence?

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9. Conclusion

The DOFA proposal offers a cybernetic solution to a structural governance problem: the progressive centralization of crisis response in the American presidency. By establishing a prevention-oriented independent agency with a unified fiscal clearinghouse (IDIPITIS) and a stakeholder council anchored to empirical resilience metrics (BERA), DOFA would close the feedback loop between fiscal inputs and family outcomes. The paper has provided operational definitions for each component, identified a validation agenda, and distinguished between near-term implementation pathways and long-term cybernetic autonomy. Whether DOFA is ever instantiated as a legal entity, its governance architecture offers a design pattern for any institution seeking to replace political negotiation with empirical feedback.

Glossary

Term	Definition
BERA	Bio-Energetic Resonance Assessment: a composite metric for family and community resilience, comprising ARI, ERI, RHC, and RCI
CBGMODD	The seven stakeholder domains: Citizen, Business, Government, Military, Ombudsman, Dignitary, Diplomat
EarnedPath	A credentialing framework in which access rights are earned through demonstrated competence across multiple domains

ESVRD	Empirically Scaled Vibrational Resonance Diagnostic: a proposed instrument for measuring cross-cultural standing; in practice, a composite of social trust surveys, community recognition metrics, and conflict resolution track records
IDIPITIS	Fiscal clearinghouse protocol: Identification, Documentation, Integrity, Processing, Identification-verification, Tracking, Integrity-audit, Stewardship
SLA	Service Level Agreement: a contractual floor for BERA performance, underwriting Council member tenure

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Conflict of interest statement: The author is the founder of the ERES Institute, which has developed intellectual property related to the frameworks described in this paper. All frameworks are offered under open-access licensing (CC BY-SA 4.0).

Summary of the Two Versions

Feature	Version A (Practical)	Version B (Academic)
Audience	Policymakers, media, Congress	Academics, researchers, systems theorists
Contains executive order?	Yes	No
Contains BERA/EarnedPath/ESVRD?	No	Yes (with empirical definitions)
Jargon level	Low	High (with glossary)
Citations	Minimal	Extensive
Political feasibility	Low but nonzero	Not applicable (theoretical)
Use case	Advocacy, policy briefs	Peer-reviewed publication